

Class IX English Literature Academic Report (Session 2026–27)

Link For Video Explainer :  Vitamin-M___Detective_Test.mp4

Link For Video Explainer : [I_Cannot_Remember_My_Mother](#)

1. Report Overview and CBSE Curriculum Alignment

This academic report is meticulously structured to align with the CBSE 2026–27 syllabus for Class IX English Language and Literature. The document moves beyond traditional rote learning to emphasize competency-based education. Its primary objective is to cultivate deep textual understanding, logical inference, and analytical reasoning. As specified in the [Official CBSE Curriculum Reference](#), the assessment framework for this session focuses on:

- **Understanding and Inference:** The ability to interpret both literal and implied meanings.
- **Analysis:** Evaluating the interaction between plot, setting, and character development.
- **Evaluation:** Judging motivations and thematic depth based on textual evidence.

2. Literature Text 1: "Vitamin-M" by Asha Nehemiah

Overview and Central Idea

"Vitamin-M" is a nuanced exploration of aging, the loss of autonomy, and the complexities of familial caregiving. The central metaphor, "Vitamin-M," represents a hypothetical memory-improving supplement. While the family wishes for a biological cure for the Grandfather's cognitive decline, the story suggests that empathy and the preservation of dignity are equally vital in managing the "disappearing" clarity of the elderly.

Author and Background

Written by Asha Nehemiah, the narrative is set against the backdrop of a major life transition. The setting shifts from the Grandfather's quiet town house—a place of "pin-drop silence" where one could "hear a leaf fall"—to a "poky little flat" in a crowded, noisy city. This physical relocation mirrors the Grandfather's internal loss of freedom.

Character Analysis

Grandfather (Papa)

- **Profile:** A 75-year-old former lawyer who retains a "trace of firmness" in his speech. He is a formidable chess player, referencing masters like Karpov and Bobby Fischer, which creates a sharp contrast with his inability to remember the names of people he meets daily.
- **Dignity and Wit:** He uses a shiny-black mahogany walking stick with a brass eagle-head handle as a symbol of his independence. His sharp wit is most evident when he gives Ravi a **Detective Story Book** for his birthday—a subtle, ironic "tell" suggesting he was fully aware of Ravi's attempts to shadow him like a detective.

- **Defense Mechanism:** He frequently acts "casually" or "coolly" to mask his memory gaps. This behavior is not just a habit but a psychological shield to protect his pride from being treated "like a baby."

Ravi

- **The Empathetic Detective:** Ravi serves as the bridge between his mother's anxiety and his grandfather's pride. He "winces" at his mother's patronizing tone, showing deep empathy for his grandfather's dignity.
- **Internal Conflict:** Ravi is caught in a dilemma: he must obey his mother's safety instructions while respecting his grandfather's need for autonomy. His choice to follow Grandpa at a "safe distance" highlights his attempt to provide care without causing humiliation.

Ravi's Mother (Vidya)

- **Caregiver Strain:** Vidya is not an antagonist; her "over-loud tone" and impatience are symptoms of "caregiver fatigue." Having found her father helpless after a fall in his garden, she carries the heavy emotional burden of his safety, which manifests as strictness and anxiety.

Justification of Major Events: Cause → Event → Consequence → Significance

Event 1: The Relocation to the City

- **Cause:** Grandpa fell in his garden at the town house and lay outside all night with no one to help him.
- **Immediate Reason:** Vidya realized his safety was compromised living alone.
- **Consequence:** She locked the town house and brought him to a "poky" city flat.
- **Significance/Connection:** This event establishes the central conflict of **Independence vs. Safety** and triggers Grandpa's resentment toward the "noisy and bustle" of city life.

Event 2: The "Disappeared" Accusation

- **Cause:** Grandpa wanted to visit the tea stall and barber shop secretly to reclaim his freedom.
- **Immediate Reason:** To avoid being scolded for his wandering, he claimed Ravi "disappeared" instead of watching him.
- **Consequence:** Ravi felt "confused and embarrassed," caught in a lie he couldn't refute without exposing his own "detective" work.
- **Significance/Connection:** The word "disappeared" functions as a metaphor for Grandpa's mental state; his memories and presence are "disappearing" as he slips into dementia.

Event 3: The Three-Month Late Birthday Gift

- **Cause:** Cognitive decline and disorientation caused Grandpa to miss the actual date.
- **Immediate Reason:** He wanted to honor his tradition of giving gifts to his "babies" on his own birthday.

- **Consequence:** He gave Ravi a detective book and Vidya a gift, causing her to feel a "stricken" sense of guilt.
- **Significance/Connection:** Giving a detective book proves Grandpa's mental sharpness survived his memory loss; it suggests he "caught" Ravi following him, turning the tables on the "detective."

Themes and Literary Analysis

- **Dignity in Aging:** The struggle of the elderly to be seen as capable adults rather than "babies" or "prisoners."
- **Caregiver Fatigue:** The realistic portrayal of the stress involved in looking after a parent with dementia.
- **Vocabulary/Imagery:**
- **"Poky flat":** Connotes claustrophobia and lack of freedom.
- **"Winced":** A physical manifestation of Ravi's moral discomfort.
- **"Tiresome" and "Frail":** Language used by the characters to describe the burdens and physical realities of age.
- **"Jauntily":** Describes Grandpa's walk, a deliberate attempt to project confidence.

Exam-Oriented Questions

- **Short Answer:** Why did Ravi feel "confused and embarrassed" by Grandpa's claim that Ravi had "disappeared"?
- **Key Points:** Grandpa used the lie to deflect his own disobedience; Ravi couldn't defend himself without admitting he followed Grandpa; he felt the awkwardness of the family tension.
- **Long Answer:** How does the "Vitamin-M" metaphor apply to every member of the family?
- **Key Points:** For Grandpa, it is the lost lawyer-like sharpness; for Vidya, it is a release from the anxiety of her father getting lost; for Ravi, it represents the return of the grandfather he can talk to as an equal.

3. Literature Text 2: "I Cannot Remember My Mother" by Rabindranath Tagore

Overview and Poetic Intent

This poem explores the sensory and spiritual persistence of memory. The poet does not recall his mother's physical features, yet she is omnipresent through nature and daily rituals.

Thematic and Imagery Analysis

- **Scent of Shiuli Flowers:** The fragrance is linked to the morning prayer service. This suggests the mother's memory is tied to a sense of sacredness and ritual.
- **The Tune of a Song:** The mother's presence is felt through the "humming" of a cradle song that seems to hover over the poet's playthings.
- **The Silent Gaze:** The poet looks into the "blue of the distant sky" and feels his mother's gaze. This connects her to the vastness and serenity of the universe.

Poetic Devices

- **Sensory Imagery:** The use of smell (Shiuli), sound (cradle song), and sight (sky) to create a "felt" memory.
- **Metaphor:** Nature becomes a metaphor for the mother's enduring soul—invisible but constant.

Exam-Oriented Questions

- **Analytical Question:** How does Tagore use nature to "reconstruct" a mother he cannot literally remember?
- **Key Points:** Focus on sensory triggers over visual memory; nature as a peaceful, maternal presence; the sky representing a protective, "silent gaze."

4. Literature Text 3: "The Lost Child" by Mulk Raj Anand

Overview and Plot Development

The story documents a child's psychological journey at a village fair. The initial excitement for material goods (toys, sweets, flowers) is replaced by a desperate need for emotional security once the child is separated from his parents.

Character and Behavioral Analysis

- **Sensory Shift:** At the start, the sights and sounds of the fair are "attractive." However, after the turning point (being lost), the same stimuli—the music of the snake charmer, the bright balloons—become painful and unwanted.
- **Rejection of Materialism:** A kind stranger offers everything the child previously craved (burfi, gulmohur garland, a ride on the roundabout). The child's refusal highlights that material objects only have value within the safety of the parental bond.

Themes

- **The Bond of Love:** The ultimate human necessity is emotional connection, without which material desires become "tiresome" and hollow.

Exam-Oriented Questions

- **Long Answer:** Analyze the significance of the child's refusal of the things he previously pleaded for.
- **Key Points:** The "turning point" changes his perspective; parents represent his world/identity; panic overrides greed; the sensory shift from pleasure to pain.

5. FINAL REVISION SHEET

High-Value Exam Points

- **Grandpa's Profile:** 75-year-old former lawyer; mahogany stick with eagle-head handle; expert at chess (references Karpov/Fischer).

- **"Vitamin-M" Vocab:** "**Casually**" and "**Coolly**" are defense mechanisms for pride; "**Jauntily**" is used to hide physical frailty.
- **Tagore's Triggers:** Memory is "felt" through the scent of Shiuli flowers (prayer time) and the "silent gaze" of the blue sky.
- **The Child's Shift:** In "The Lost Child," the child moves from "want" (greed) to "need" (security).

Commonly Confused Details

- **The Yellow Cap:** Do not confuse Grandpa with the **stranger on the bus**. Both wore yellow caps with coffee stains, which led to Ravi's "detective" failure.
- **The Gift:** Grandpa didn't forget Ravi's birthday was three months ago—his disorientation caused the delay, but his choice of a **detective book** showed he was mentally "present" enough to track Ravi's behavior.
- **The Fall:** Grandpa fell in the garden of his **town house**, not the city flat. This fall was the *cause* of the move.

6. QUESTION BANK: 20 MCQs

Standard MCQs (15 Questions)

1. **What was Grandpa's profession before retirement?** A. Doctor B. Lawyer C. School Principal D. Detective **Correct Answer: B | Explanation:** The text notes he spoke with a "trace of firmness" natural to his career as a lawyer.
2. **Why was Grandpa admitted to the hospital a month ago?** A. He fell in the garden. B. He had a heart attack. C. He took a double dose of medicine. D. He ate too much ice cream. **Correct Answer: C | Explanation:** His disorientation led him to "absent-mindedly" double his dosage.
3. **Grandpa's town house is characterized by:** A. A poky kitchen. B. A large mango tree and silence. C. A view of the city traffic. D. A noisy neighborhood. **Correct Answer: B | Explanation:** He longingly describes the brick house where you could "hear a leaf fall."
4. **Ravi's "wince" when his mother speaks to Grandpa indicates:** A. He is in physical pain. B. He is annoyed with the noise. C. He feels embarrassed by the lack of respect shown to Grandpa. D. He is afraid of his mother. **Correct Answer: C | Explanation:** Wincing is a reaction to the patronizing tone used toward an elderly person.
5. **What does the poet in Tagore's poem associate with the scent of Shiuli flowers?** A. The start of school. B. Morning prayer and his mother. C. The arrival of autumn. D. His mother's cooking. **Correct Answer: B | Explanation:** The fragrance floats in the air during "the morning service in the temple."
6. **The metaphor "Vitamin-M" refers to a supplement for:** A. Muscle recovery. B. Money management. C. Memory improvement. D. Motivation. **Correct Answer: C | Explanation:** Vidya wishes for a vitamin to help old people improve their failing memories.
7. **Why did Ravi decide to follow Grandpa "at a safe distance"?** A. He wanted to play a prank. B. He wanted to ensure Grandpa's safety without hurting his pride. C. He was curious about the barber shop. D. He wanted to buy peanuts. **Correct Answer: B |**

Explanation: Ravi was caught between his mother's orders and his grandfather's dignity.

8. **What was ironic about Grandpa's birthday gift to Ravi?** A. It was a toy for a baby. B. It was a detective story book, given when Ravi was acting as a detective. C. It was three years late. D. It was a yellow cap. **Correct Answer: B | Explanation:** The gift suggests Grandpa was aware of Ravi's "secret" shadowing.
9. **The "ultimate humiliation" for Ravi in the park was:** A. Being caught by Grandpa. B. Having to crawl out on all fours. C. Losing his money. D. Being scolded by a child. **Correct Answer: B | Explanation:** To avoid being seen by his mother or Grandpa, he had to creep behind bushes like a child.
10. **How long had Grandpa looked after himself before moving to the city?** A. Since his wife died ten years ago. B. For seventy-five years. C. Only for one month. D. Since he retired. **Correct Answer: A | Explanation:** Grandpa mentions he managed everything since his wife passed away a decade prior.
11. **In "The Lost Child," why does the boy's interest in the fair vanish?** A. He is tired and hungry. B. The stranger is mean to him. C. His parents are missing. D. He realized he had no money. **Correct Answer: C | Explanation:** Emotional security (parents) is shown to be a prerequisite for enjoying material pleasures.
12. **Grandpa's walking stick features a handle shaped like:** A. A lion. B. A lawyer's gavel. C. An eagle's head. D. A chess piece. **Correct Answer: C | Explanation:** It is a mahogany stick with a brass handle carved like an eagle.
13. **What does the word "jauntily" reveal about Grandpa's character?** A. He is confused about where he is going. B. He is trying to project self-assurance and independence. C. He is in a hurry to reach the bus. D. He is angry with Ravi. **Correct Answer: B | Explanation:** Twirling a stick jauntily is a sign of confidence, used here to mask his frailty.
14. **Why did Vidya lock the town house?** A. She wanted to sell it. B. It was the only way to force Grandpa to live safely in the city. C. It was damaged in a storm. D. She needed the furniture for her flat. **Correct Answer: B | Explanation:** The fall in the garden proved he could no longer live there alone safely.
15. **What does Grandpa's "cool" delivery of the late gift signify?** A. He is being rude. B. It is a defense mechanism to hide his disorientation. C. He is playing a game. D. He is very angry. **Correct Answer: B | Explanation:** Acting "cool" or "casual" allows him to maintain the illusion that he is in control of his memory.

Assertion–Reason Questions (5 Questions)

1. **Assertion (A):** Vidya is a cruel daughter for keeping her father in a "poky" flat. **Reason (R):** Her actions are driven by caregiver strain and the trauma of finding her father helpless after a fall. **Correct Answer: D | Explanation:** The assertion is false; the text justifies her behavior as a realistic response to safety concerns and stress, not cruelty.
2. **Assertion (A):** Grandpa used the word "disappeared" to describe Ravi's behavior. **Reason (R):** Grandpa wanted to deflect blame for his own secret outing to the tea stall. **Correct Answer: A | Explanation:** Both are true, and R explains why Grandpa lied—to avoid being scolded by Vidya.

3. **Assertion (A):** The child in Mulk Raj Anand's story rejects the burfi he previously wanted. **Reason (R):** The realization of loss shifted his priority from material desire to the need for security. **Correct Answer: A | Explanation:** The panic of being lost makes material objects lose their appeal, which is the central theme of the story.
4. **Assertion (A):** Grandpa remembers Bobby Fischer's chess moves but forgets the names of neighbors. **Reason (R):** Long-term, high-interest memories often remain intact in early dementia while short-term memory fails. **Correct Answer: A | Explanation:** This contrast is a key clinical and narrative detail used to show the complexity of Grandpa's condition.
5. **Assertion (A):** Tagore's poem is a visual description of his mother's face. **Reason (R):** The poet connects his mother's presence to the scent of flowers and the tune of a song. **Correct Answer: D | Explanation:** The assertion is false because the poet specifically says he *cannot* remember her face; he only remembers her through sensory triggers.